

Project Anime



Playtest Guide

Introduction

Welcome to **Project: Anima**, before we get into the game, we want to extend a heartfelt thank you to everyone that is playtesting this TTRPG. It is a joy trying to figure out a simple way to build a game for all to enjoy. **Project: Anima** was created for the love of stories created from anime, light novels, and manga. The goal was to create a setting agnostic system that the players of this TTRPG can create whatever world they wish. It is for this reason that the Core Rulebook is a small document. Our goal is to expand with different Modules as the game gains steam. Some of these will be Free that are inspired by different stories that we love, while others will be rule enhancements.

Thank you for giving us a shot!

What to Expect

This isn't going to be a massive introduction, or complete rules. As this is still only a playtest, expect to only see the rules for **Character Creation, Combat, and Non-Combat Rules**. Do not expect anything that would be considered extra to this setting-agnostic system. This includes **Crafting, Mounted Combat, Homebrewing, Travel & Exploration**, and various other rulesets. These will come with time, but we have a focus.

How will Playtesting Work?

Playtesting will happen twice a week, approximately, for an entire month. During that month of playtesting, we will collect feedback, before moving to another version. This is to make sure we have plenty of time to gain feedback and improve the system.

The system will not improve until we've had time to catalogue them. Each Playtest will have a theme. With this trying to emulate and be capable of emulating any game, most of the playtests will have a single setting, and we will be trying to build around that aspect. Most of these rules will not actually include those settings. However, if asked, we will give how we created it the way we did!

Credits and Information

Version: 0.01
Changelog: Here
Designer: Vinny
Team: Hellfire, CSwrites
Special Thanks:
Play Testers:

Art: Artwork is temporary to give the guide a little bit of life. This will be replaced over time as we develop the game. Artwork rights belong to each of the artists and no money is being made on this project as of yet. When and If it does, we will commission for actual art.

Game Rules

This chapter features the core rules required to play **Project: Anime**. This chapter should be read thoroughly regardless if you are the Game Master or player. It should also be readily available to check back often.

Throughout this chapter the mechanics are presented in a way that felt intuitive. However, you may have to jump between pages to get the full picture of how the game works.

Changing the Rules

As is most common with TTRPGs, the rules presented in this chapter and in this book are more suggestions than hardline rules to the game. As you grow more familiar with the rules of **Project: Anime**, feel free to make adjustments to the ruleset, create and remove Skill creation components, and even try new systems in the ruleset completely.

Project: Anime focus is to create a setting agnostic system, so feel free to change these rules to fit the world, the story, and even the genre you want to run. A word of caution to this design philosophy, check in with your group and discuss them as it is a collaborative game, make sure everyone is heard.

Scenes

You must first understand the concept of **scenes**, before you can play the game. Scenes divide up a story across units of time and space. Scenes in this game are like scenes in an anime.

Not everything should be a scene. Only the most important parts of a story are singled out as a scene. A heart to heart between two **Party Members**, combat with a villain, but even lesser moments that serve the story can also be counted as a scene, like discovering a hidden shop.

Conversely, story beats that are unimportant such as daily chores, small talk, even some shopping scenes don't need to be covered and should be omitted.

Conflict Scenes

When the actions of the Player Characters are threatened and have a reasonable chance of failure it constitutes a **conflict scene**. This can be as simple or as complex as combat, negotiations, a chase, etc. It is when two opposing forces come in conflict with one another. During a conflict, the characters' actions are tracked in greater detail.

Interlude Scenes

Sometimes, there will be moments where a story beat will be at a slower pace; these scenes, typically, are traveling, shopping, downtime, etc.

During an **interlude scene**, each Player describes the general task or objective their character performs. These are simple and small scenes. However, as soon as a player sparks interest in parts of the interlude scene, this should switch back to a standard scene.

Storyteller Scenes

Every once and a while, there might be a perfect scenario where a **storyteller scene** might be more appropriate. It is a scene that exists without the Players. This scene can be used to show an evil organization, or something happening elsewhere in the world. It can be used to foreshadow events.

Storyteller scenes are an excellent way to add depth, character, and intrigue to the overall story.

Rest Scenes

A Rest Scene is a pause in the story for the party to rest, and it comes in two kinds: a Camp on the road and a Town in a settlement. A Camp is short and quiet, time to make a campsite, bond, or trade a few words. A Town is a longer stretch of resting and relaxing in a settlement. The setting is only flavor. If training atop a waterfall fits the moment better than an inn, that still counts as a Rest Scene. For what a rest restores and the downtime it allows, see **here**.

Other Important Rules

- ❖ **Disposition:** The term **creature** includes both PCs and Npcs. The term **ally** is anyone that the character believes is on their side, while the term **enemy** indicates opposition. If an effect targets allies, you cannot use it on yourself.
- ❖ **Always Round Down:** Whenever something says halve or divide, round down. The minimum is 1, except for damage, where the minimum is 0.
- ❖ **Specific Trumps General:** If a specific element of the game contradicts a general rule, that specific element will take precedence.

Attributes

A character's Attributes are an abstract representation of their training and natural talents in different fields.

- ❖ **Might** represents a character's physical strength, endurance, stamina, and the ability to survive. You will need Might to push, move, and carry objects, fight with heavier weapons, and to keep fighting. It is also your ability to withstand pain and is tied to **Hit Points**.
- ❖ **Agility** measures a character's precision, coordination, balance, reflex and speed. You will need Agility to dodge attacks and skills, to move faster than others, and fight using weapons that require more finesse.
- ❖ **Mind** represents mental strength and fortitude. It represents memory and the ability to recall details. You will need Mind to assess situations in combat, understand and command magical types of weapons, and perceive the world around you.
- ❖ **Spirit** measures life force, energy, and willpower. Your spirit is your limitation on energy, resist mental effects and speak from the heart. It is also your ability to use Skills, in the form **Energy**.
- ❖ **Charm** represents charisma, persuasion, and the art of seduction. You use your Charm for diplomacy and other Checks that influence others around you. Your Charm is also utilized to manipulate and influence the world around you in the form of Luck Dice.

Each Attribute has a value, an even number from 4 to 12, and a die to match: a value of 4 is a d4, a value of 12 is a d12. In these rules, «Attribute» means that value. Where a rule adds or multiplies «Attribute», use the number; where a rule tells you to roll «Attribute», roll the die of that size. The value you set at character creation is your base value. As an Attribute increases or decreases through play, its current value is the size it has now; its base value never changes.

Step Up and Step Down

To Step Up a die, replace it with the next larger size; to Step Down, replace it with the next smaller. The sizes run d4, d6, d8, d10, d12. A die never rises above d12 or falls below d4, and a step past either limit has no effect.

Combat Stats

Combat Stats are the numbers that govern how a character performs in combat.

- ❖ **Hit Points** represent a character's ability to take damage before being knocked out.
- ❖ **Energy** represents a character's stamina and the ability to continuously manipulate it into Skills.
- ❖ **Evasion** represents a character's ability to avoid being hit. It may represent dodging attacks as well as deflecting them.
- ❖ **Movement** represents a character's speed and ability to maneuver around the battlefield.
- ❖ **Carrying Capacity** represents the amount a character can lift either through sheer force or by dragging.

Luck Dice

Luck Dice represent good fortune you can spend to change the outcome of a roll. At character creation, roll your «Charm» die three times and record the three results as your Luck Dice.

After a Check is rolled, but before the result is read, you may replace one of its two dice with one of your numbers. This works on any Check, your own, an ally's, or an enemy's.

That number is then spent. You restore Luck Dice by resting; see here.

Checks

When you perform an action, you use your Attributes to determine success or failure. This is called a **Check**.

In general, you make a Check:

- ◆ **When required by the rules.** Attacking with a weapon or using a Skill often requires a Check to determine success or failure. Effects that do not explicitly call for a Check always succeed automatically.
- ◆ **When asked by the Storyteller.** The Storyteller has the right to ask you to make a Check when you attempt a risky action, face opposition, or react to danger.

Checks always require **exactly two dice**.

Tests

Tests are used to see if a character is able to successfully complete an action. A Test is a Check against a Challenge Threshold, used only when the action is not a simple affair and success is not guaranteed.

Tests should not be used if it is a mundane or simple task that is trying to be achieved.

Success: The total of the dice + modifiers is equal to or greater than the Challenge Threshold.
Failure: The total of the dice + modifiers is less than the Challenge Threshold.

Challenge Threshold	Difficulty
7	Easy
10	Normal
13	Hard
16	Daunting
19	Extreme

Contested Checks

A Check is contested when two or more characters or parties compete. Each one makes a Check, adding any modifiers that apply, and the highest total wins. On a tie, ignore the results and repeat until someone wins.

Circumstantial Modifiers

Depending on situations, a Storyteller may decide that a situation favors your character, giving you a +1 or +2 bonus to your Check. However, the Storyteller may also decide that your character is in an awkward position that calls for a -1 or -2 penalty instead.

Retrying Checks

There is absolutely no rerolling of a Check.

Wren’s Tip!

Avoid calling for Checks when the result of the dice must be a success. If failing or succeeding doesn’t matter then there shouldn’t even be an attempt at a roll!

Character Creation

Character creation in **Project: Anime** involves 6 simple steps. We recommend you follow them in order. However, if you have more experience with TTRPGs or with this system, feel free to skip around.

1. **Concept**
2. **Distribute Attribute Steps**
3. **Calculate Combat Stats**
4. **Create Skills**
5. **Purchase Gear**
6. **Finishing Touches**

Concept

This is the first step of creating your character. Spend some time thinking about who your character is as a person first. While you are coming up with ideas, think about the kind of skills you'd want them to have, and what makes them unique. All of this can assist you in creating a character you'll enjoy.

Distribute Attribute Steps

Determine the base dice size of your character's five Attribute scores: Might, Agility, Mind, Spirit, Charm. Each starts at d4. Distribute five Step Ups among them.

For example, say you want a hard-hitting bruiser. Spend three Step Ups on Might (d4 to d6 to d8 to d10) and two on Agility (d4 to d6 to d8): Might is now d10 and Agility d8, with Mind, Spirit, and Charm left at d4. Or spread them one per Attribute, so each begins at d6.

Calculate Combat Stats

Your Combat Stats are calculated as follows:

Calculate Hit Points and Energy

◆ **Hit Points** = $\langle\langle \text{Might} \rangle\rangle \times 2$

◆ **Energy** = $\langle\langle \text{Spirit} \rangle\rangle \times 2$

Your character begins the game with full Hit Points and Energy.

While you configure Hit Points and Energy using your attribute, this is only determined at character creation, even if your attributes would increase, Hit Points and Energy are never recalculated.

Calculate Evasion, Carrying Capacity, and Movement

Your additional combat stats are calculated as follows:

◆ **Evasion** = $\langle\langle \text{Agility} \rangle\rangle$

◆ **Carrying Capacity** = $\langle\langle \text{Might} \rangle\rangle + 3$

◆ **Movement** = $\langle\langle \text{Agility} \rangle\rangle / 2 + 3$

When an attribute increases, Evasion, Carrying Capacity, and Movement are calculated by their current value, not their base value.

Create Skills

Your character begins with **6 Skill Points**. This is a representation of the starting power level of the setting and the game. When creating your Skills follow the guidelines as demonstrated **here**.

Purchase Gear

You start with a total budget of **1500G** to purchase gear, items, and equipment. At character creation, you are only able to purchase **armor, consumables, gear, shields, and weapons**.

Accessories and other items are not able to be purchased when starting out.

All items you purchase you are able to rename to better fit your character's vibe. A sword is just a category, but it might become a katana or a greatsword.

Finishing Touches

Name your character, decide gender and pronouns, and briefly describe their appearance and personality.

Skills

Skills are abilities and techniques you create for your character to use. They are built through Skill Points and require several components: **Action Type, Effect, Modifier, Range, and Rank**. Some skills may require **Damage Types** or a **Trigger**.

Creating a Skill

A concept is as important as creating the initial Skill. What does this Skill look like? What does it do? If you know the concept, it will be easier to create the Skill.

Action Type

An **Action Type** is the measurement of time it takes to unleash a skill.

- ◆ **Action.** This Skill uses your action and requires Energy to use.
- ◆ **Passive.** This Skill is always active and doesn't require Energy to use.
- ◆ **React.** This Skill uses a reaction and requires Energy to use.

Rank

Rank is represented by a number of ★s. The more ★s the stronger power level the Skill. Rank determines the following:

- ◆ **SP Cost:** The cost to initially create the Skill.
- ◆ **Energy Cost:** The amount of Energy expended whenever you use the Skill.
- ◆ **Maximum Modifiers:** The amount of customizations allowed to enhance the Skill.

Some **Effects** adjust the power level of a Skill depending on its **Rank**.

Rank	Name of Rank	SP Cost	Energy Cost	Max Modifiers
★	Basic	1	2	1
★★	Intermediate	2	4	2
★★★★	Advanced	3	6	3
★★★★★	Expert	4	8	4
★★★★★ ★★	Master	5	10	5

Attributes

Attributes are the two stats you roll when the Skill is used. If the Skill deals damage or heals, choose one of its two Attributes. You roll that Attribute's die for the damage or healing.

Note: Attributes are determined by you and the Storyteller. For balance, it is recommended to choose two **different** attributes.

Range

All Skills have a **Range**, a scope that determines how far away you can affect a target. Ranges are defined for single-target Skills, but also for the center point for AOES. You and the Storyteller set the value of the range. These are just recommendations.

- ◆ **Self.** Applies to you.
- ◆ **Weapon.** Weapon's range
- ◆ **Melee.** Any tile within your reach
- ◆ **Near.** Up to 5 tiles.
- ◆ **Far.** Up to 10 tiles.
- ◆ **Very Far.** Anywhere within the Scene.

Damage Types

Skills that deal damage have a damage type. **Physical** is the most common for Skills. However, they can be any Damage Type that works for the world (Example: Earth, Fire, Mental, Sonic, Water, Wind, etc).

Trigger

Triggers are conditions that must be met before a Skill can activate. These are used only for React Skills. Every **React Skill** must have a Trigger.

- ◆ **Alerted.** You have sensed or perceived something specific, described when the Skill is designed.
- ◆ **Attacked.** You or an ally within the Skill's Range is targeted by an attack.
- ◆ **Critical.** You enter Critical.
- ◆ **Damaged.** You or an ally within the Skill's Range takes damage from an attack.
- ◆ **Enters.** An ally or enemy enters or moves through your reach.

Effect

Every Skill has an Effect that determines what it does. An Effect can change based on the Rank of the Skill.

Affinity

- ★: Gain Resist to a Damage Type.
- ★★★★: Gain Immunity to a Damage Type or Status Effect.
- ★★★★★★: Gain Absorb to a Damage Type.

Special: Resistance and Immunity to Physical damage costs one Rank higher to obtain. (e.g., Intermediate Rank for Resist Physical, Expert for Immune to Physical)

Bolster

- ★: Raise one Attribute of the target by 1.
- ★★★★: Raise two Attributes of the target by 1.
- ★★★★★★: Raise three Attributes of the target by 1.

Special: This follows the normal hierarchy (4->6->8->10->12). Bolster can only raise an attribute up to its maximum.

Hinder

★: Lower one Attribute of the target by 1 or inflict one Status Effect.

★★★★: Lower two Attributes of the target by 1.

★★★★★★: Lower three Attributes of the target by 1 or inflict two Status Effects.

Special: This follows the normal hierarchy (12→10→8→6→4). Hinder can only lower an attribute up to its minimum.

Mend

Restore a number of Hit Points to the target equal to the Attribute die.

Move

★: Move up to your Movement +2, or force-move the target up to 2 tiles.

★★★★: Move up to your Movement +4, or force-move the target up to 4 tiles.

★★★★★★: Move up to your Movement +6, or force-move the target up to 6 tiles.

Special: If the target of this Skill is yourself, it lets you move. If the target is another creature, a successful Accuracy Check lets you move that target instead.

Sense

★: Sense creatures or items within Range.

★★★★: Sense creatures or items within Range x2.

★★★★★★: Sense creatures or items beyond the Scene, to a distance agreed upon with the Storyteller.

Special: Sense must have a defined scope. Example scopes include Magic Sense or Ki Sense (to detect creatures and items that emit magic or possess Ki), as well as sensory types like Echolocation or Scent. Sense still requires a Check.

Strike

Deal Hit Point damage or Energy damage to the target equal to the Attribute die. Resolve this damage as an attack (see Damage).

Sustain

★: Regenerate 2 HP or Energy at the start of your turn.

★★★★: Regenerate 4 HP or Energy at the start of your turn.

★★★★★★: Regenerate 6 HP or Energy at the start of your turn.

Modifiers

A modifier adjusts and shapes a Skill with added effects. These effects fuel into the overall power of a Skill. Skills can have a number of modifiers equal to the Rank of the Skill. (See Rank above.) Modifiers marked with **Heavy** counts as 2 Modifiers.

- ◆ **Burst.** The Skill affects everything with 2 tiles of a chosen point within the Skill's Range.
- ◆ **Chain.** When the Skill hits a target, it leaps to one more target within Near of the target, then to one more within Near of that target. Each successive hit deals half the damage of the previous one. The user must hit each target before the leap can continue.
- ◆ **Charge.** You spend a turn focusing and roll the Accuracy Check. On a hit, the Skill resolves on your next turn with double damage or healing. On a miss, the Charge dissipates and you may act normally on your next turn.
- ◆ **Cleanse.** Remove a Status Effect from the target of this Skill.
- ◆ **Decay.** The target takes 1 damage at the end of their next 3 turns.
- ◆ **Devour.** *Heavy.* This Skill can only target a creature that has been reduced to 0 HP, or one you reduced to 0 HP. You copy and learn one Skill that creature knows.
- ◆ **Drain Energy.** You restore Energy equal to half the damage dealt.
- ◆ **Drain HP.** You heal HP equal to half the damage dealt.
- ◆ **Inflict.** Inflict the target with a Status Effect.
- ◆ **Line.** The Skill affects everything in a straight line up to the Range of the Skill.
- ◆ **Mass.** *Heavy.* The Skill affects all valid targets within the Skill's Range. You choose which targets are affected.
- ◆ **Pierce.** The Skill ignores the target's Defense.
- ◆ **Pull.** The target moves one tile closer to you. This is Forced Movement.
- ◆ **Push.** The target moves one tile away from you. This is Forced Movement.
- ◆ **Reflect.** The Skill turns an incoming attack into momentum or against the user. When this Modifier is chosen, choose either **Bounce** or **Counter**.
 - ◆ **Bounce:** The incoming attack/Skill is redirected at its source and resolved with the attacker's own Accuracy and Damage. Their attack turned around; you take nothing.
 - ◆ **Counter (parry):** you make an immediate strike back with your weapon's Accuracy and Damage against the attacker.

Gear

Regardless of the Module or the world you find yourself in. Characters will find themselves purchasing and selling items. This section covers the basics of economy and a list of items and prices.

Gold (G)

While many worlds have their own currency. **Project: Anime** uses Gold, a universally accepted currency. Depending on the world, prices may vary and gold may be easier or harder to obtain.

Carrying Capacity

Every item has a Size, a single number for its bulk and weight, listed in the Size column of each gear table. Add up the Size of everything you have equipped and everything you carry. While that total is greater than your Carrying Capacity, Step Down both dice on every Check.

Shopping Rules

You may purchase gear and items while shopping as long as you are able to pay the listed gold (G) cost. Shopping is done in shops found in towns, traveling merchants, or even rare artefacts that may contain shops. Gear and other items may be limited based on Storyteller discretion.

You may sell unnecessary or extra gear or items for half of their list price.

Equipment

A type of gear that is equipped to your character is called Equipment. There are four types of equipment: **Accessories, armor, shields, and weapons.**

Slots

A Player Character can equip a limited number of equipment on their person at one time:

- ◆ **Main Hand.** Your main hand can equip a one-handed weapon or you can change your grip to two-handed. If you are gripping a weapon in two hands, you do not have access to your off-hand.
- ◆ **Off-hand.** Your off-hand can equip a one-handed weapon or a shield.
- ◆ **Armor Slot.** You have one equipment slot for your armor.
- ◆ **Accessory Slot.** You have two equipment slots for your accessories.

Accessories

Accessories are magical items that are usually worn, such as a piece of jewelry, belt, boots, etc that grant the wearer unique special abilities.

Armor

Armor offers protection to its wearer. Lighter armor does not have penalties to Evasion, but offer no protections. Heavier armor has penalties to Evasion, but offers more protections.

Shields

A shield equips in your main hand or off-hand and counts as a weapon, so you can attack with it. While you wield a shield, add its Evasion Bonus to your Evasion. If you wield two shields, only the higher Evasion Bonus applies.

Weapons

There are no specific weapons. Instead, weapons are listed as a group to allow for maximum customization. Player Characters can equip a sword and it can be considered a katana, longsword, greatsword, or scimitar.

Accessories

Each accessory lists its Name, Size, Cost, and the effect it grants while equipped.

Accessory	Size	Price
Belt of the Titan	1	750G
You gain +4 to your maximum Hit Points.		
Lucky Pendant	1	1500G
When you roll your Luck Dice, Step Up your «Charm» die for the roll.		
Running Sandals	1	750G
You gain a +1 to Movement		
Trader's Pass	1	2000G
You sell items for 60% instead of 50%.		
Scouter	1	1000G
You can see the total amount of Skill Points of anyone you can see.		

Armor

Each armor lists its Defense Bonus and Evasion Penalty, along with its Name, Size, and Cost.

Armor	Size	Price
Clothes	0	100G
No Defense ◆ No Evasion Penalty.		
Light Armor	1	250G
+1 Defense ◆ No Evasion Penalty		
Medium Armor	2	500G
+2 Defense ◆ -1 Evasion		
Heavy Armor	3	1000G
+3 Defense ◆ -2 Evasion		

Shields

Each shield lists its Evasion Bonus, Accuracy (the two attributes you roll to attack with it), Damage modifier, and Range, along with its Name, Size, and Cost.

Shield	Size	Price
Light Shield	2	150G
+1 Evasion ♦ 《Might》 + 《Agility》 ♦ DMG -1 ♦ Melee/ 1 Tile		
Heavy Shield	5	400G
+2 Evasion ♦ 《Might》 + 《Might》 ♦ DMG ♦ Melee/1 Tile		

Weapons

Each weapon lists its Accuracy (the two attributes you roll), Damage modifier, and Range, along with its Name, Size, and Cost.

Dual Wielding

Player Characters that wield a weapon and/or shield in their **main** and **off-hand** slots can dual wield. While dual wielding, both Damage dice Step Down one step each. Dual Wielding counts as two attacks and are reduced by Defense separately.

Grip

Player Characters can hold any weapon, except for bows, in one or two hands. If held in two hands, the Damage die Steps Up one size. If the Damage die is already a d12, wielding the weapon in two hands gives +1 damage instead.

Weapon	Size	Price
Axe	3	500G
《Might》 + 《Might》 - 1 ♦ DMG + 1 ♦ Melee/1 Tile		
Blade	2	600G
《Might》 + 《Agility》 ♦ DMG ♦ Melee/1 Tile		
Bow	3	1000G
《Agility》 + 《Mind》 ♦ DMG ♦ Ranged/8 Tiles		
Chain	2	800G
《Agility》 + 《Charm》 ♦ DMG - 1 ♦ Melee/ 3 Tiles		
Firearm	3	1000G
《Agility》 + 《Mind》 -1 ♦ DMG +1 ♦ Ranged/6 Tiles		
Grimoire	1	800G
《Mind》 + 《Spirit》 -1 ♦ DMG+1 ♦ Ranged/5 Tiles		
Polearm	3	700G
《Might》 + 《Agility》 ♦ DMG +1 ♦ Melee/2 Tiles		
Staff	2	700G
《Mind》 + 《Spirit》 ♦ DMG ♦ Melee/1 Tile		
Unarmed	—	—
《Might》 + 《Agility》 ♦ DMG -2 ♦ Melee/1 Tile		

Consumables

Consumables are single-use items. Using one in combat takes your Action. . Once it is used, it is expended and cannot be used again. Each consumable lists its Name, Size, Cost, and the effect it grants when consumed.

Consumable	Size	Price
HP Potion	1	100G
Restores 4 HP		
Strong HP Potion	1	300G
Restores 8 HP		
Energy Drink	1	100G
Restores 4 Energy		
Strong Energy Drink	1	300G
Restores 8 Energy		

Containers

Each container lists its Carrying Capacity bonus, along with its Name, Size, and Cost.

Container	Size	Price
Pouch	—	100G
+1 Carrying Capacity		
Small Backpack	—	300G
+3 Carrying Capacity		
Backpack	—	500G
+5 Carrying Capacity		
Large Backpack	—	1000G
+10 Carrying Capacity		

Advancement

In **Project: Anime** there are no levels. In order to increase their power, a Player Character must earn **Skill Points** or **SP**.

You gain **SP** through different tasks and objectives, typically given by the Storyteller at the end of adventure conclusions. Here is a list of common objectives that give SP.

- ❖ **Discovery.** Accidental or through extended exposure. Discovery happens when a character might be constantly exposed to poison and built up a tolerance to it, they might learn a **Poison Immunity Skill**.
- ❖ **Episode, Arc, and Season Rewards.** Whenever the party successfully finishes an episode, arc, or season. A number of SP will be earned by the entire party.
- ❖ **Training Downtime.** Downtime is another way to earn SP and learn new various skills.

When you Advance

Advancement requires a rest. You spend Skill Points at a Camp or a Town.

Spending Skill Points

Skill Points can be spent on the following:

- ❖ **Improving Attributes:** Each step has its own cost, and they are cumulative if you try to advance more than one step at once. No Attribute may exceed d12.
- ❖ **Improving Combat Stats:** You can spend SP to improve your Combat Stats. Each has its own cost and benefit.
- ❖ **Learning a New Skill:** You can spend SP to learn a completely new Skill following the creation rules.
- ❖ **Improving a Skill:** You can also spend SP to improve Skills you already know.

Improving Attributes

Improvement	Cost
4 to 6	1 SP
6 to 8	2 SP
8 to 10	3 SP
10 to 12	4 SP

Improving Combat Stats

Improvement	Cost	Benefit
Max HP	1 SP	+2 HP
Max Energy	1 SP	+2 Energy
Movement	3 SP	+1 Movement
Carrying Capacity	1 SP	+1 Carrying Capacity

Learning a Skill

Learning a new Skill works just like creating one during Character Creation. Spend a number of SP equal to the Skill's Rank.

Improving Skills

You may improve a Skill you already know by spending SP. Pick which part of the Skill you wish to improve. As with Skill creation, all improvements are subject to Storyteller approval.

- ❖ **Add a Modifier.** *1 SP.* The Skill gains a new Modifier from the list. Total Modifiers may not exceed the Skill's Rank.
- ❖ **Lower Energy Cost.** *1 SP.* The Skill's Energy cost drops by 1 to a minimum of half of the base cost.
- ❖ **Raise Range.** *1 SP.* The Skill's Range increases by 1.
- ❖ **Raise Rank.** *1 SP.* Skills gain the benefits of their Rank changing.
- ❖ **Sharpen Accuracy.** *1 SP.* Add +1 to the Skill's Accuracy Check. Maximum +3.
- ❖ **Sharpen Damage.** *1 SP.* Add +1 to the Skill's Damage roll. Maximum +3.
- ❖ **Sharpen Healing.** *1 SP.* Add +1 to the HP the Skill restores. Maximum +3.
- ❖ **Sharpen Move.** *1 SP.* Add +1 to the tile the Skill can move. Maximum +3.
- ❖ **Turn a Modifier.** *1 SP.* One Modifier's numerical value grows. Examples include: Burst +1 tile to the radius, Chain: +1 targets it leaps to, Push: +1 tile to pushing

Combat

This chapter covers a fight from start to finish: setting up the battlefield, the flow of turns, making attacks, the status effects that result, and what happens when a character is defeated.

Setting Up Combat

Combat plays out on a grid. Before it begins, the Storyteller sets up the battlefield.

The Grid

Combat uses a grid of square tiles. A tile has no fixed size in feet or meters; it is the unit the game counts distance in.

Distance is counted one tile at a time, and a diagonal step counts the same as a straight one. The eight tiles surrounding a creature are adjacent to it, corners included.

Only one creature occupies a tile at a time.

Line of Sight

To attack or affect a target at range, you need a clear line to it: a straight line from your tile to the target's with nothing solid in the way.

Walls, pillars, dense growth, and other solid obstacles block that line. Other creatures do not. An ally or enemy standing between you and your target does not break the line.

Taking the Field

The Storyteller builds the battlefield and decides where everyone begins: the distance between the two sides, the obstacles on the ground, and any notable features. Players place their characters within the space the Storyteller describes.

Flow of Combat

Combat runs in rounds. In each round, every participant takes one turn, in order of Initiative.

Initiative

At the start of combat, each participant makes an Initiative Check: roll «Agility» + «Mind». The highest total takes the first turn, and play continues in descending order until everyone has acted. The order holds for the rest of the combat.

On a tie, the larger «Agility» die goes first; if those match in size, tied players choose their order, and an enemy goes before any player it ties with.

The Turn

At the start of your turn, resolve any start-of-turn effects, such as the HP or Energy returned by Sustain. You then take one Move and one Action, in either order. You may split your Movement, spending part of it before your Action and the rest after.

Trivial efforts, such as speaking a few words or dropping a held item, cost nothing and do not use your Action. The Storyteller decides what qualifies.

Movement

Your Movement, set in Combat Stats, is the greatest number of tiles you may move on your turn. You may move fewer tiles, or none at all.

You may pass through a tile occupied by an ally. You may not pass through a tile occupied by an enemy.

Leaving a tile next to an enemy draws no attack on its own. The only thing that punishes movement is a React Skill built on the Enters trigger.

Forced Movement caused by a Skill, such as Push or Pull, is separate from your Movement and follows the rules of that Skill.

Actions

On your turn you may take one Action.

- ◆ **Basic Attack.** Strike with your equipped weapon. See Making an Attack.
- ◆ **Use a Skill.** Activate one of your Skills that uses an Action and pay its Energy cost.
- ◆ **Use an Item.** Use a consumable or an equipped item with a use effect.
- ◆ **Other Action.** Attempt anything not covered above. The Storyteller decides whether it is possible and what roll, if any, it requires.

React Skills

A React Skill activates the instant its Trigger fires, on any creature's turn rather than only your own. When the Trigger is met and you choose to use the Skill, pay its Energy cost and resolve it.

You may activate one React Skill in response to a single Trigger event. Separate Trigger events may each prompt a React Skill, limited only by the Energy you can spend.

Some Triggers fire before their action resolves, such as Attacked or Enters, and the React Skill resolves first, before that attack or movement completes. Others fire after, such as Damaged or Critical, and the React Skill resolves once the action has happened.

Ending the Round

When the last participant in the Initiative order has finished their turn, the round ends and a new round begins, following the same Initiative order.

Making an Attack

An attack is a strike with your equipped weapon. A Basic Attack costs no Energy. A Skill that strikes with your weapon uses the same procedure and adds its own effect and Energy cost.

Every attack follows three steps: choose a target within your weapon's Range, make an Accuracy Check to see whether you hit, and roll Damage if you do.

Fumble and Combo

Two results on an Accuracy roll override the total. If both dice show 1, the attack is a Fumble: it misses regardless of the total.

If both dice show the same value of 6 or higher, the attack is a Combo: it hits regardless of the total, and the moment it resolves you take an additional turn. A Combo can happen only on your own turn, and a turn gained from one cannot itself produce another.

Range

Every weapon and Skill has a Range, and a target must be within it to be attacked. A weapon lists its Range in its entry. A Skill's Range is set when it is built.

Accuracy

Choose a target within Range and roll the two attribute dice listed for your weapon, adding the weapon's Accuracy modifier and any other modifiers. If the total meets or beats the target's Evasion, the attack hits; otherwise it misses.

Cover raises a target's Evasion. When a low wall, doorway, or other obstacle stands between it and the attacker, the Storyteller adds 1 or 2 for as long as the cover holds.

Damage

On a hit, roll your weapon's Damage die, whichever of its two attributes you choose, and add the weapon's Damage modifier and any other bonuses. Then resolve the total in order:

1. Apply any elemental interaction.
2. Subtract the target's Defense.
3. Deal what remains, to a minimum of 0.

Defense is damage reduction from equipped armor, applied only to Hit Point damage. A character without armor has Defense 0.

Affinities

A creature may have an Affinity to a damage type, granted by a Skill such as Affinity or set by the Storyteller. A creature has at most one Affinity to a given type, and Affinities do not stack.

- ◆ **Weak.** The creature takes 2 extra damage.
- ◆ **Resist.** The creature takes 2 less damage.
- ◆ **Immune.** The creature takes none.
- ◆ **Absorb.** The creature takes none and instead regains Hit Points equal to the damage.

Status Effects

A status effect is a condition placed on a character by a Skill, Modifier, or other source. Each status lasts a number of turns set by its source, with a default of 2. A status counts down at the end of the affected character's turn and ends when it reaches 0. A character can carry several different statuses at once, and applying the same one again refreshes it to the longer remaining duration rather than stacking. Some effects, such as the Cleanse modifier, end a status early.

- ◆ **Blinded.** Step Down both dice of an Accuracy Check.
- ◆ **Bound.** Cannot move.
- ◆ **Decay.** Takes 1 damage at the end of each turn.
- ◆ **Exhausted.** Cannot activate Skills.
- ◆ **Prone.** Cannot move, and Step Down both dice of an Accuracy Check.
- ◆ **Slowed.** Movement is halved.
- ◆ **Stunned.** Loses its next turn entirely, taking no Move and no Action. Stunned then ends, rather than lingering like the others.

Critical, Defeat, and Death

When a character's Hit Points fall below 25% of their maximum Hit Points, rounded down, they are in Critical. Some Skills trigger on entering it.

When a character's HP reaches 0, they are Defeated. A Defeated character cannot move or act and is helpless. HP never falls below 0, and further damage to a Defeated character has no added effect.

A Defeated character is down, not dead. Healing that raises their HP above 0 brings them back at once. They return to the fight and take their turns normally from then on, at their usual place in the Initiative order.

When combat ends, any character still Defeated recovers to half their Max HP, rounded down.

Death is never caused by damage or by reaching 0. It enters play only when a fight is wholly lost, an entire side Defeated at once, or as a deliberate moment the table agrees on. At that point the table decides what the loss costs: capture, a lasting wound, or death. If you would rather players hold that choice, let each decide their own character's fate on a total loss.

Resting

Resting restores Hit Points, Energy, and Luck Dice. It is also when characters spend Skill Points to advance (see Advancement). There are two kinds: Camp, a short rest, and Town, a longer rest in a settlement.

Downtime

Downtime is what a character does during a rest, apart from recovering. It comes in two tiers. Minor Downtime is short and light: talking, planning, or light practice, with no mechanical cost. Major Downtime takes a longer, dedicated stretch and includes Training.

Camp

The Storyteller decides when the party can Camp. A Camp costs nothing, and every character present gains its benefits.

Each character restores Hit Points equal to half their Max HP and Energy equal to half their Max Energy, up to their maximum. A character benefits from a Camp only once in a 24 hour period.

A Camp allows Minor Downtime.

At the end of a Camp, each character may roll their «Charm» die once to restore one spent Luck Die; the value rolled becomes that Luck Die.

Town

A Town represents a full day. Each character restores Hit Points and Energy to full.

A Town allows Major Downtime.

At the end of a Town, each character rolls their «Charm» die three times, replacing all their Luck Dice.

Training

Training is a Major Downtime activity that earns Skill Points. A character who trains for a full week, doing nothing else that week, earns 2 Skill Points. Training requires no roll.